

Beat the Engine: The Chess Reasoning Layer

Chess tools tell players what the best move was. **Beat the Engine** captures why they chose their move — and turns that reasoning into engine-grounded coaching data. This is not another engine UI. It is a structured reasoning-data product.

Candidate Ideas → Commit Move → Engine Analysis → AI Reflection → Progress Data

THE PROBLEM

Chess Training Optimizes Answers, Not Thinking

Existing tools evaluate moves well but cannot diagnose the player's decision process. The gap is not chess analysis — it is structured reasoning capture.

Current Tools Show

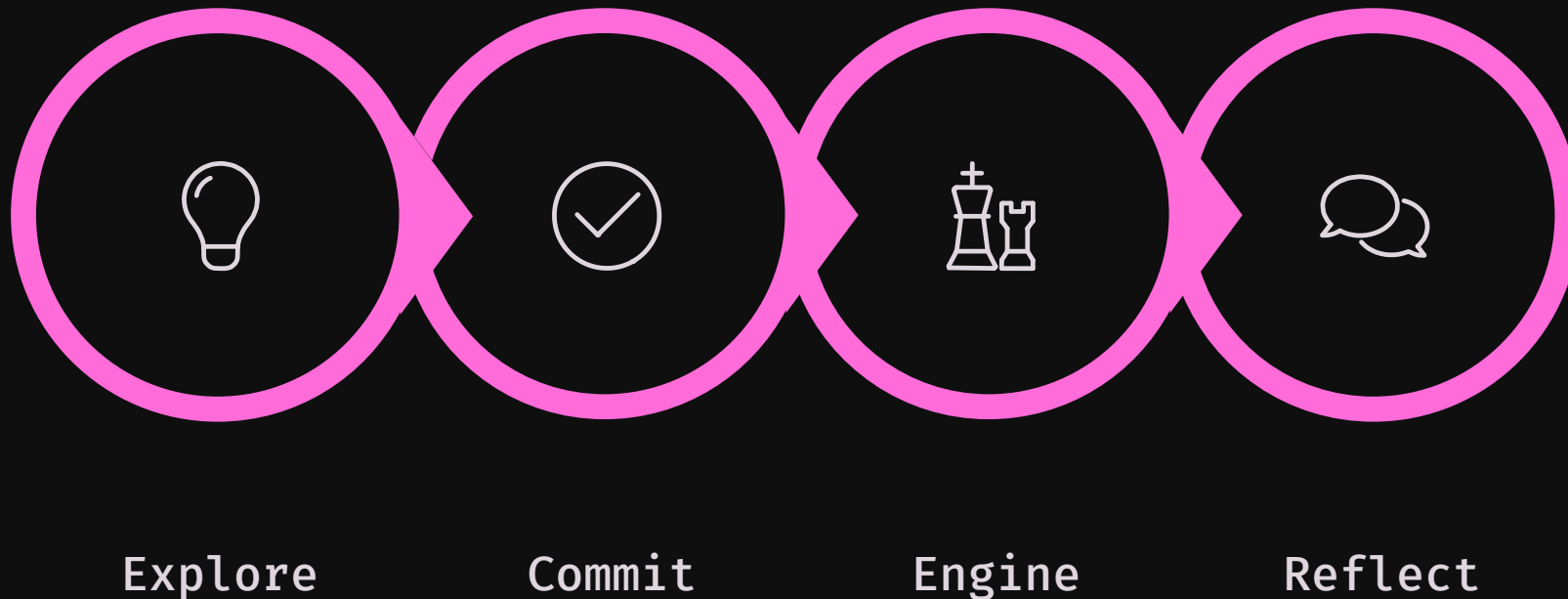
- Best move and evaluation swing
- Tactics puzzle result
- Generic post-game explanation

What They Miss

- Alternative moves the player considered
- Why the player selected their move
- Whether reasoning quality improves over time

A Deliberate-Move Workflow

Beat the Engine forces a higher-signal training loop: draft candidates, explain intent, commit one move, then receive grounded feedback.



i "Before the engine tells you the answer, the product captures what you thought was happening."

TARGET CUSTOMER

Built for Improvers, Coaches, and Clubs

Start B2C for speed, expand B2B through coaches and clubs. Each segment unlocks higher retention and lifetime value.

1

Serious Improvers

900–1800 Elo players already spending on Chess.com, Lichess, books, and engines

2

Coaches

Need student thinking logs, not just game results

3

Clubs & Academies

Scalable training assignments and review data

4

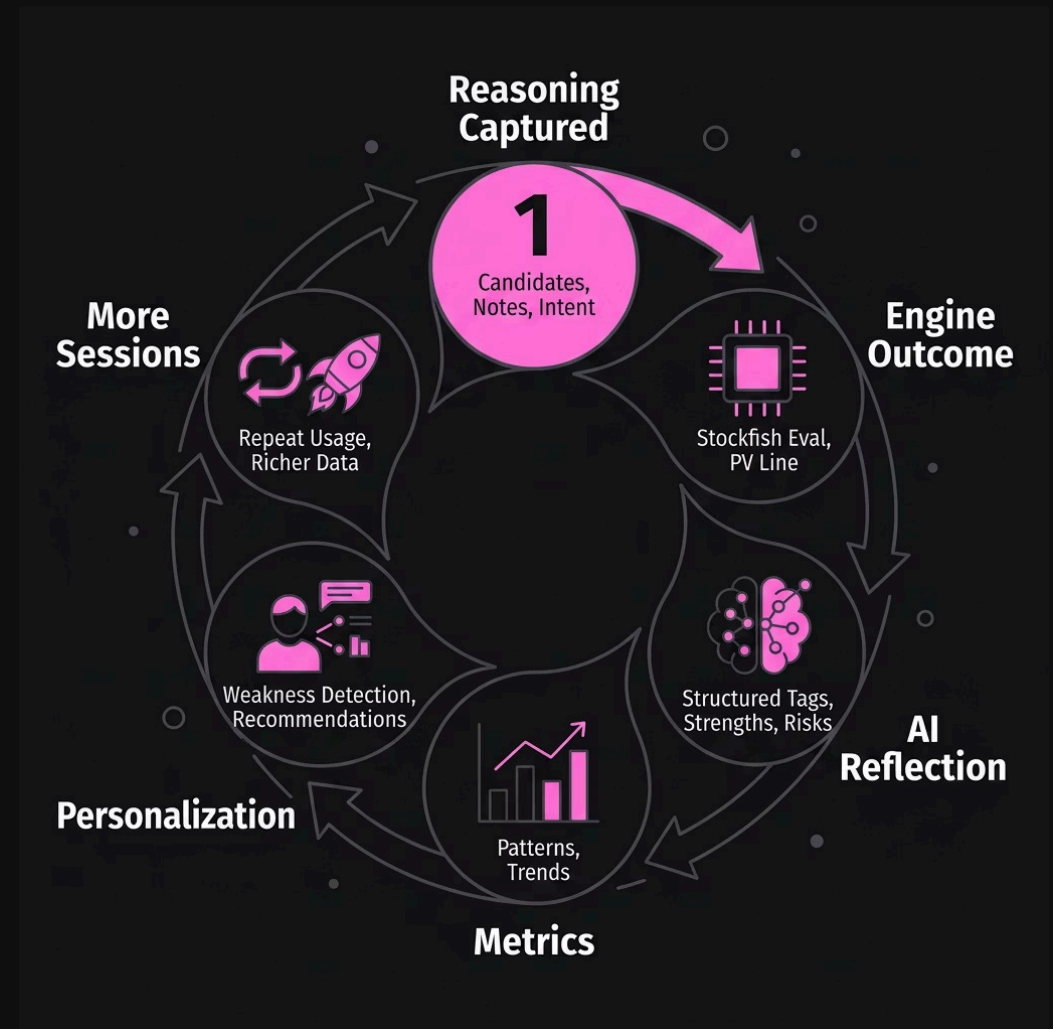
Platform

Online communities, school clubs, and titled-coach content businesses

The Proprietary Asset Is Reasoning Data

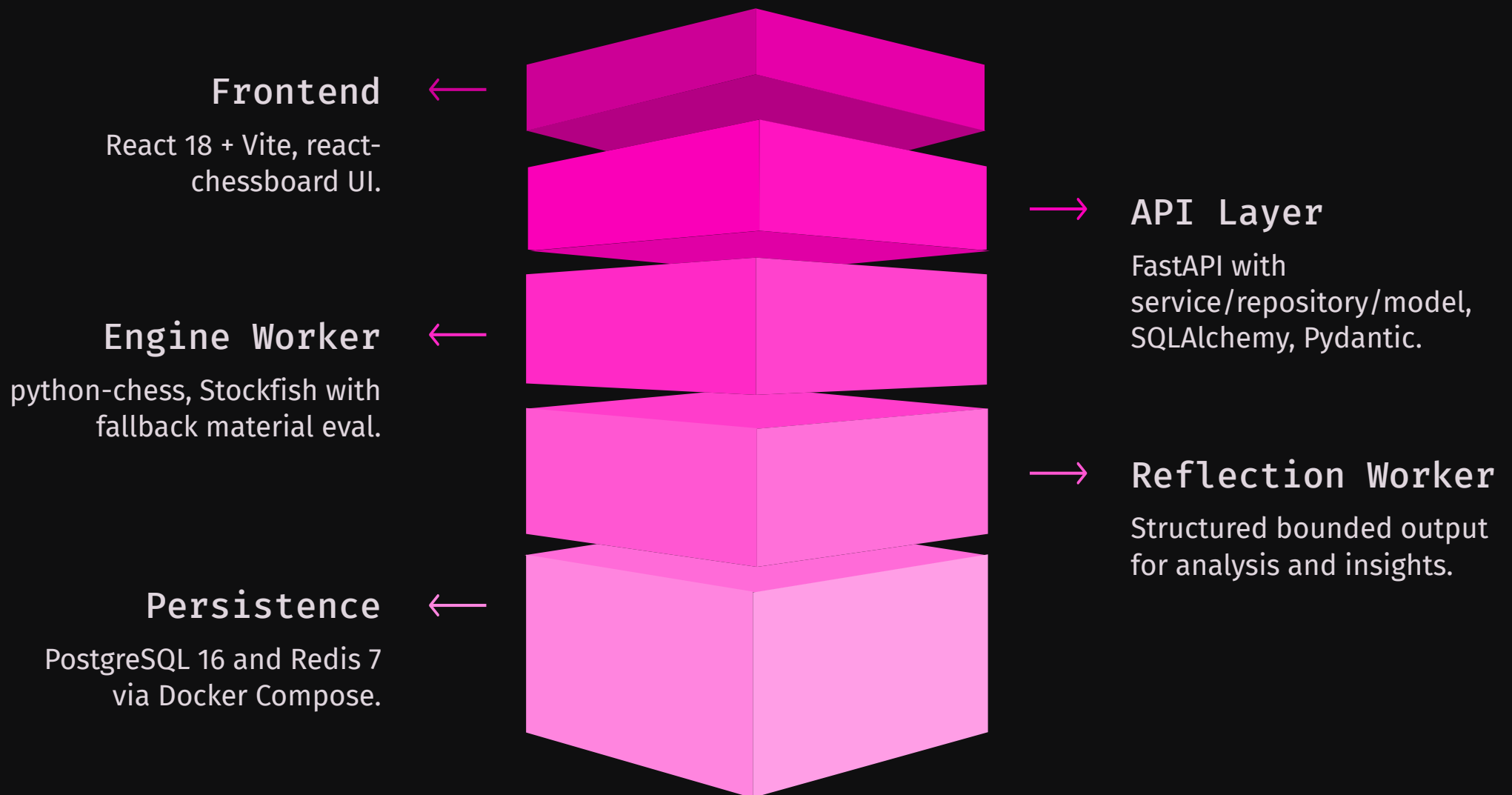
Each turn generates a structured data record that no competitor naturally collects. Over time, this becomes a defensible dataset for personalization, coach dashboards, and pattern detection.

- Position FEN and candidate moves
- Selected move and reasoning text
- Eval before/after and engine principal variation
- Reflection tags and model version



Working MVP With Modular Architecture

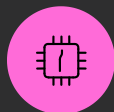
Containerized full-stack system with separable services — frontend, API, engine worker, reflection worker, and persistence layer — all running independently.



Stockfish runs open-source. Reflection is short, structured, and bounded. Not every interaction requires expensive AI inference — keeping infrastructure costs low at scale.

Bounded AI, Engine-Grounded Output

This is not an uncontrolled chatbot. It is a constrained analysis layer attached to chess-engine evidence — auditable, versioned, and safe.



Engine-Grounded

Reflection tied to Stockfish eval and principal variation



Timeout-Bounded

Reflection capped at 3 seconds; commit always succeeds



Versioned

Model version stored per session for quality comparison



Fallback-Safe

Material evaluation when Stockfish is unavailable

Subscription Plus Coach and Club Licensing

Revenue Tiers

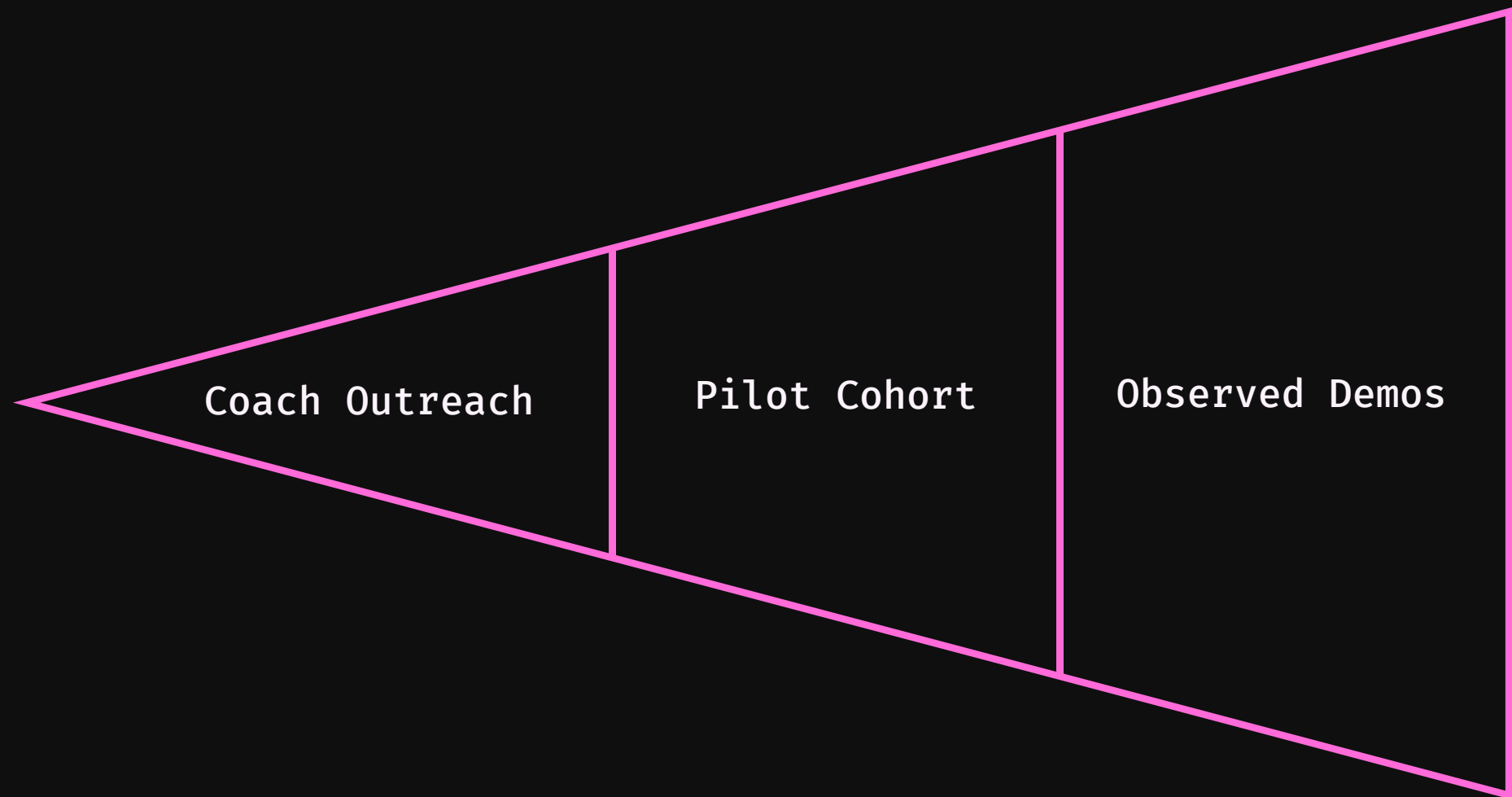
- **Free:** Limited sessions/month
- **Pro Individual:** Unlimited reasoning and history
- **Coach:** Student management and review dashboard
- **Club:** Multi-seat, shared reporting, assignments

Cost Advantage

- Stockfish runs open-source — no per-call API cost
- Reflection is short, structured, and bounded
- Not every interaction requires expensive AI inference
- Candidate evaluation uses engine worker or fallback paths

Pilot-Led GTM Through Coaches and Serious Improvers

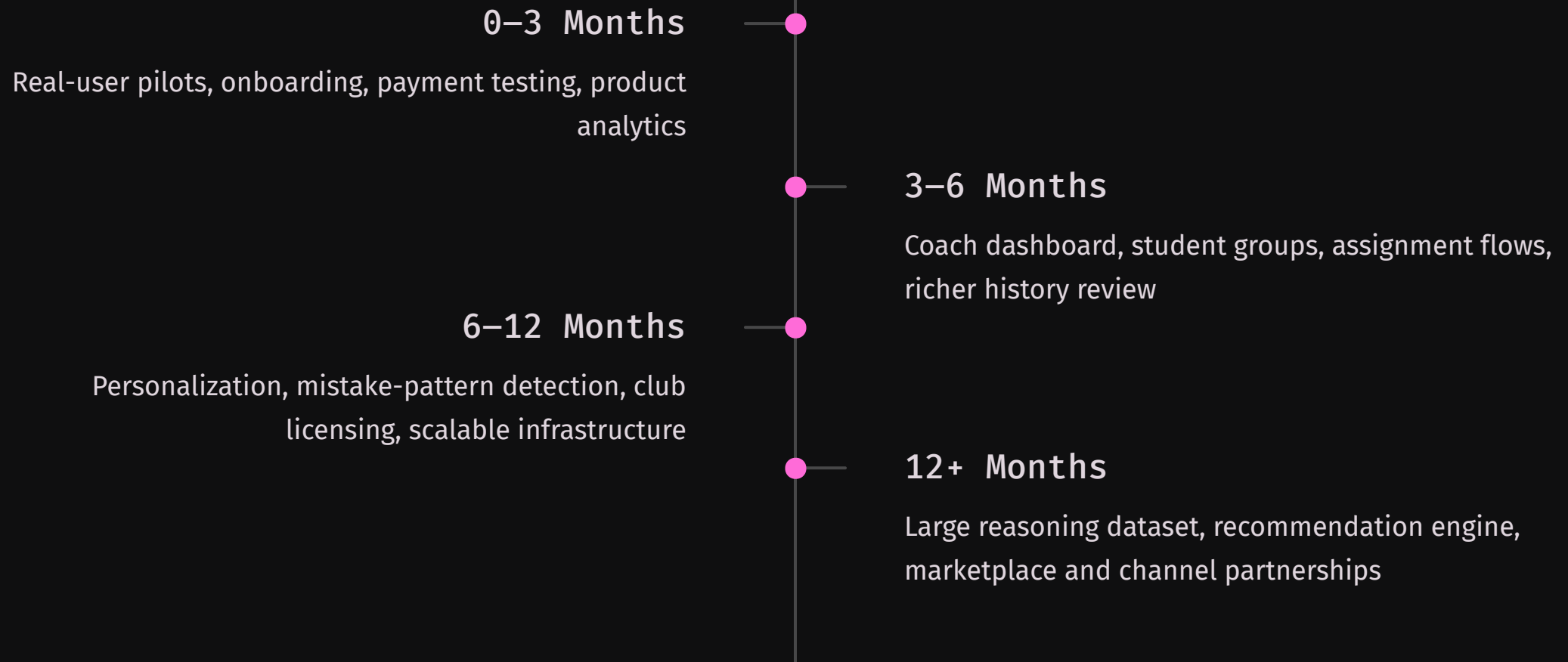
The MVP is pilot-ready. Next milestone: real-user validation with players and coaches who already pay for improvement.



Key metrics to validate: session completion, candidates per commit, repeat usage, reflection usefulness, willingness to pay, coach review frequency.

❏ Simulated users are product-testing evidence — not market traction. Real pilot data is the next milestone.

From MVP to Coach-Ready Platform



✅ **Milestones to unlock next round:** Active pilot coaches · Paid individual subscribers · Repeat-usage cohort · Coach dashboard adoption · Cost per active user understood

"Beat the Engine starts as a chess training product — but the long-term asset is structured decision-making data for competitive improvement."